

BEFORE YOU LAUNCH

4 Things You Need Ready

Before You Start Building Your AI App

*A practical checklist + copy-paste prompts
to generate every document yourself*

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Why This Matters

Shipping an AI app is exciting — but the moment real users start typing into it, you're collecting data, making promises, and taking on liability, whether you've written it down or not. Most builders bolt these documents on after launch, or worse, never do. The four documents below aren't legal decoration; they're the guardrails that keep your app, your users, and you out of trouble.

Two of these are the obvious, non-negotiable pair. The other two are the ones people skip — and the ones that matter most specifically because your product is powered by AI.

1. Privacy Policy

The non-negotiable — required by law in most jurisdictions the moment you collect user data.

A Privacy Policy tells users exactly what data you collect, why, how it's stored, who it's shared with, and what rights they have over it. For an AI app this also means being explicit about whether user inputs are sent to a third-party model provider (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, etc.) and whether that data is used for training.

What it should cover:

- What personal data you collect (account info, usage data, device data)
- Whether user prompts/inputs are sent to a third-party AI provider, and which one
- Whether data is used to train or fine-tune any model
- Data retention periods and how users can request deletion
- Third-party services you rely on (analytics, hosting, payment processors)
- Compliance basics relevant to you: GDPR, CCPA, or India's DPDP Act
- Contact details for privacy-related requests

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

Act as a privacy lawyer. Write a clear, plain-English Privacy Policy for my AI app called [APP NAME]. The app does [SHORT DESCRIPTION]. It collects [LIST OF DATA: e.g. email, name, usage logs, user prompts]. User inputs are sent to [AI PROVIDER, e.g. OpenAI/Anthropic API] for processing, and [ARE / ARE NOT] used to train models. We use [LIST TOOLS: e.g. Stripe, Google Analytics, Firebase]. We are based in [COUNTRY] and our users are mainly in [REGION(S)]. Include sections on data collected, purpose, third-party sharing, AI data handling, retention, user rights, cookies, children's privacy, and contact information. Keep the tone professional but easy to understand.

2. Terms & Conditions

The non-negotiable — sets the rules of the road and limits your liability.

Terms & Conditions (or Terms of Service) is the contract between you and your users. It defines acceptable use, ownership of content, payment terms, and — critically for an AI app — disclaims responsibility for AI-generated output that may be inaccurate, biased, or unexpected.

What it should cover:

- Who can use the app (age restrictions, eligibility)
- License granted to users vs. what you retain ownership of
- Payment, subscription, and refund terms if applicable
- AI-specific disclaimer: outputs may be inaccurate and should be verified
- Prohibited uses (illegal activity, abuse, scraping, reverse engineering)
- Limitation of liability and disclaimer of warranties
- Termination rights and governing law / jurisdiction

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

Act as a contract lawyer. Write a complete Terms & Conditions document for my AI app called [APP NAME], which does [SHORT DESCRIPTION]. Pricing model is [FREE / FREEMIUM / SUBSCRIPTION, with details]. Include a clear AI disclaimer stating outputs may be inaccurate, incomplete, or unsuitable for professional advice, and that users are responsible for verifying results before relying on them. Include sections on eligibility, user accounts, acceptable use, intellectual property, payment and refunds, disclaimers of warranty, limitation of liability, termination, and governing law in [COUNTRY/STATE]. Write in plain English, organized with numbered headings.

3. AI Usage & Data Disclosure

The one most builders forget — and the one users increasingly ask for.

This document specifically addresses how AI works inside your app: which model(s) power it, what its known limitations are, and how much a user's input might be seen or retained by a third party. It's increasingly expected by app stores, enterprise customers, and privacy-conscious users, and it builds trust by being upfront instead of vague.

What it should cover:

- Which AI model(s)/provider(s) power the app, named explicitly
- Whether responses are AI-generated and may contain errors ('hallucinations')
- Whether the app has human review or moderation of outputs
- Data flow: what part of a user's input leaves your servers and where it goes
- Whether outputs are used to further train or improve any model
- Any age or use-case restrictions (e.g. not for medical/legal/financial decisions)
- How users can report a bad or harmful AI output

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

Act as an AI product policy writer. Write a short, clear 'AI Usage & Data Disclosure' page for my app called [APP NAME]. It uses [AI PROVIDER/MODEL, e.g. Claude, GPT-4, Gemini] to power [FEATURE, e.g. chat responses, content generation, recommendations]. Explain in plain language: that responses are AI-generated and can be inaccurate or biased, whether there is human review, what data from the user's input is sent to the AI provider and why, whether it's used for model training, and any restrictions on use (e.g. not medical, legal, or financial advice). End with how users can flag a problematic response. Keep it under 500 words and easy for a non-technical user to understand.

4. Acceptable Use & Content Moderation Policy

The one that protects you when someone inevitably misuses the app.

An Acceptable Use Policy spells out exactly what users are not allowed to do with your AI app — generating harmful content, impersonation, spam, abuse, or attempts to jailbreak the model — and what happens when they do. Pairing this with a lightweight moderation/enforcement policy gives you a documented basis to suspend or ban bad actors, and shows platforms (app stores, payment processors, cloud/AI providers) that you're operating responsibly.

What it should cover:

- Explicit list of prohibited content and behavior (illegal, hateful, harmful, sexual content involving minors, harassment, malware, etc.)
- Rules against attempting to bypass safety filters or 'jailbreak' the AI
- Rate limits, abuse, and automated scraping restrictions
- How violations are detected (automated filters, user reports, manual review)
- Enforcement actions: warnings, suspension, permanent bans
- Appeals process for users who believe they were wrongly actioned

- Statement that you comply with, and may report to, relevant authorities where legally required

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

Act as a trust & safety policy writer. Write an Acceptable Use Policy for my AI app called [APP NAME], which does [SHORT DESCRIPTION]. List clearly prohibited uses, including generating illegal, hateful, sexually explicit, or harmful content, harassment, impersonation, spam, malware, and attempts to bypass or manipulate the AI's safety systems. Describe how violations are detected (automated filters and/or user reports), the enforcement ladder (warning, temporary suspension, permanent ban), and a simple appeals process. Keep the tone firm but fair, organized with clear headings, and end with a note that we cooperate with law enforcement where legally required.

Quick-Start Checklist

Before you open your app to real users, make sure each box is checked:

- Privacy Policy published and linked in-app and on your website
- Terms & Conditions published and accepted at signup (checkbox, not just a footer link)
- AI Usage & Data Disclosure visible near the AI feature itself, not buried in settings
- Acceptable Use Policy linked, with a working 'report content' flow in the app
- All four documents dated and version-numbered so you can track updates
- A named contact (email) for privacy, legal, and abuse reports

A note before you paste these prompts

These prompts will get you a strong first draft — not a substitute for a lawyer. Once your app has real users and revenue, it's worth a quick legal review, especially for the Privacy Policy and Terms & Conditions.

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